

Silent MSI Application Deployment via Group Policy (GPO)

Objective:

Deploy software silently to domain-joined machines using Group Policy with .msi installers, ensuring no user interaction is required during installation.

Requirements:

- Domain Controller (Windows Server)
- .msi installer for the application
- Shared network folder accessible by all target computers (e.g., \\DC1\Software\Chrome)
- Organizational Unit (OU) with target computers
- Administrative rights

Step 1: Prepare the Software Share

1. Create a shared folder (e.g. C:\Software on DC1)
2. Share it as: \\DC1\Software
3. Share Permissions: Add Everyone with Read access (or Domain Computers)
4. NTFS Permissions:
 - Domain Computers → Read & Execute
 - Optional: Domain Users → Read
5. Place .msi installers inside (e.g., GoogleChromeStandaloneEnterprise64.msi)

Step 2: Create a New GPO for Application Deployment

1. Open Group Policy Management Console (GPMC)
2. Right-click your target OU → Select Create a GPO and name it (e.g., Deploy Chrome)
3. Right-click the GPO → Edit

Step 3: Assign Software via GPO

For machine-wide (system) installation:

Navigate to:

Computer Configuration → Policies → Software Settings → Software Installation

Right-click → New → Package

Browse to:

\\DC1\Software\Chrome\GoogleChromeStandaloneEnterprise64.msi

Select “Assigned” and click OK.

Important: Always use UNC paths (\\server\share) — never local paths (e.g., C:\...)

Optional: User-based Installation

For user-specific deployment:

Go to:

User Configuration → Policies → Software Settings → Software Installation

Same steps apply. This is useful if software is user-scoped rather than system-scoped.

Step 4: Apply and Test

1. Link the GPO to the correct OU containing target PCs
2. On the client machine:

Run:

`gpupdate /force`

Then restart to trigger installation.

Software will install silently at next boot (Computer Configuration) or next login (User Configuration).

Example: Google Chrome Enterprise

Installer path: `\\DC1\Software\Chrome\GoogleChromeStandaloneEnterprise64.msi`

Deployment type: Assigned to Computer

Installs silently on startup across all PCs in the OU — no user input required.

Notes:

- Only .msi files are supported via GPSI (for .exe, use scripts or third-party tools like SCCM)
- If install fails, check:
 - NTFS and share permissions
 - MSI compatibility (x64 vs x86)
 - Event Viewer logs (Application and System)